



ONE ARM PLANCHE



ДАВАЙ
CALISTHENICS



davaicalisthenics.com

Introduction	3
Glossary	3
Visualization/mindset	4
Anatomy & muscle strain	5
Presentation of the sided planches family	7
Warm-up	9
First steps	10
Sided planches	11
Assisted one arm planches	12
Logic for obtaining the one arm planche	12
One arm planche on the ground	13
OAP lean	13
OAP 'banana'	16
OAP 'pike' or 'wallet'	16
OAP 'bent arm'	17
OAP 'clean form'	17
Ground variants	19
OAP pushup	19
OAP press	20
One arm planche on parallel bars	21
OAP lean	23
OAP negative	26
Breathing	29
Variants on parallel bars	30
OAP press	30
OAP pushup	30
One arm planche on fingers	31
OAP by Lee Van	31
OAP by Valentin	33
OAP press	33
Training synthesis	34
Muscles/injuries	36
Specific one arm planche conditioning	37
Thanks	42
Legal notice	42

INTRODUCTION

GLOSSARY

Side : gives two definitions for the one arm planche :

Version 1, 'virgulated' side : particular positioning of the body which aims to impose a curvature between the rib cage and the pelvis, the desired amplitude being such that the line of the upper dorsal vertebrae (upper back) forms the smallest possible angle with the lumbar vertebrae (lower back);

Version 2, 'twisted' side : positioning where the pelvis remains in the axis of the spine and rotates approximately 45° around the axis of the spine, so as to orient the pelvis towards the ground ;

Anterior arm chain : muscle chain in the front that starts at the anterior deltoid and ends at the wrist, passing through the biceps, then the inside of the elbow and the forearm ;

Posterior arm chain : muscle chain at the back that starts at the infraspinatus and ends at the wrist (little finger side), passing through the triceps, then the outside of the elbow and the forearm ;

Skill : movement of calisthenics and street workout ;

OAP : one arm planche ;

Handstand : hand balance ;

Virgulated : type of side planche (where the body forms a shape resembling a comma) ;

Center of gravity : point of application of the resultant of the forces of gravity applied to the whole body. The fact of placing it vertically of the load point (for example the hand in OAP) allows the balance ;

Press : action allowing the body to rise to the outstretched arm handstand (or one arm handstand), mainly induced by a contraction of the deltoids ;

Lean : advancement towards a skill with the body extended, up to the alignment of the center of gravity towards the support, keeping contact with the ground (or another support), allowing to reduce the leverage exerted before the lift-off . Reinforcement exercise which allows to reduce the leverage compared to the real skill.

VISUALIZATION/MINDSET

Visualizing a skill is a very important step in your progress. Not only for the one arm board but also for all the other skills and for training in general. What do we mean by visualization ?

It's very simple : in conversations with our friends during training, or even at any time of the day, without having to think about it beforehand, we can say to ourselves «Oh yes, I could do this skill today!» or «I'd like to try this one !».

After seeing a movement in real life or on the networks, it can be very inspiring, so much so that a ash lights up your brain and you think «Oh, I have to practice this move !».

It is because of these things that happen in our mind, in our thoughts, that we keep the motivation we need, and that we have fun in the long run ! Sticking to training in the form of a program of «8 repetitions of this skill, 2 minutes of recovery», who cares about that ? What is really important is that you do what you want, what you enjoy, what you visualize !

Visualizing a movement during or outside of training, imagining yourself doing it, is sending a positive image to your brain that you are able to perform the movement you are thinking about. Your chances of success will increase tenfold. Focusing and visualizing on music that gives you a particular emotion can also amplify this phenomenon.

On the other hand, practicing a movement without any conviction, being defeatist «It's too hard, I can't do it» is totally counterproductive, or having a discomfort in the form of pain in the body : this second case is more frustrating because it prevents you from visualizing correctly despite your good will, it happens to everyone and it can happen sometimes. You have to reduce these bad thoughts by working on yourself.

Our sport is above all a mental workout, and this workout has a great impact on your training : believing in yourself is not to be taken lightly at all, and it is simply essential to become a high level athlete who performs.

Believe in yourself, do not let go of your goals and take it one step at a time. Learn how to listen to your body, to heal it (yes, your mind can really accomplish great things).

Learn to sincerely visualize the skills you want to achieve, be passionate, take pleasure in your work, and your progress will only get better ! ДАВАЙ !

ANATOMY AND MUSCLE STRAIN

The anterior and lateral deltoids : they allow the abduction and the antepulsion of the arms (more precisely humerus). That is to say that they allow you to lift your arms forward and to the sides. These are the muscles that are mostly used in one arm planche. You will mainly have to strengthen this area to obtain significant strength gains.

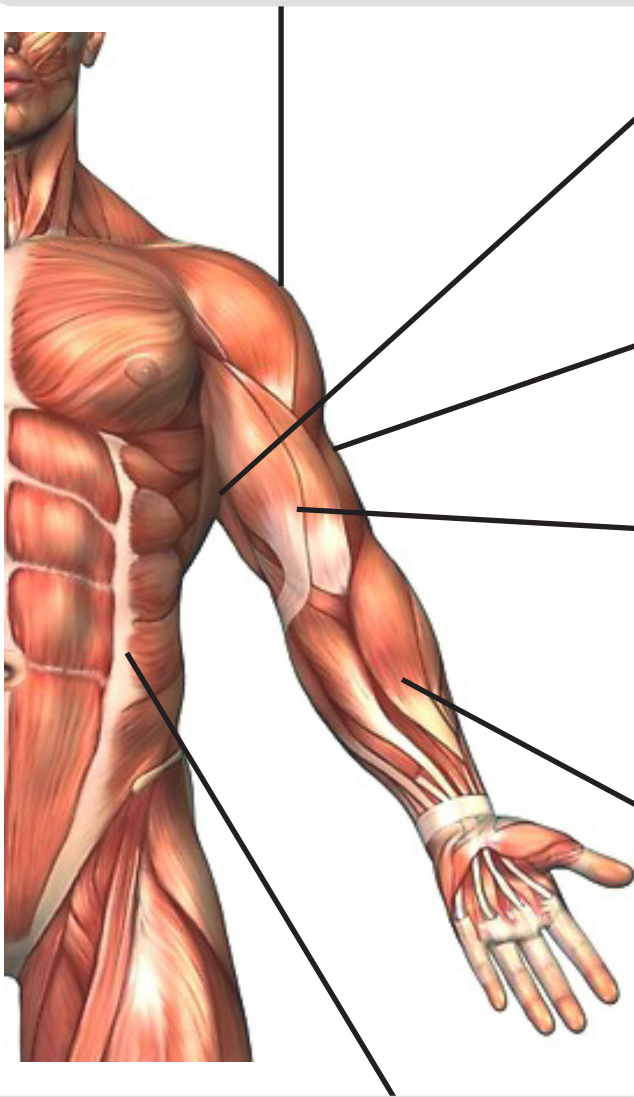
The large dorsal muscles : they allow the adduction and the retropulsion of the arms (more precisely humerus). That is to say, they allow you to bring your arms towards your body or to move them away from your body. In one arm planche, their role is different and a little more specific. Indeed, when the dorsalis major is mobilized in an isometric way on a well executed movement, it allows to protect and stabilize the sensitive areas such as the intercostal muscles or the scapula. This muscle allows you not to be slumped, and thus avoid big tensions and injuries.

The triceps : these muscles allow mainly the extension of the arms but also their retropulsion. In one arm planche, the triceps is the muscle that allows the back restraint during the management of the balance. It is also greatly solicited during the one arm planche pushup.

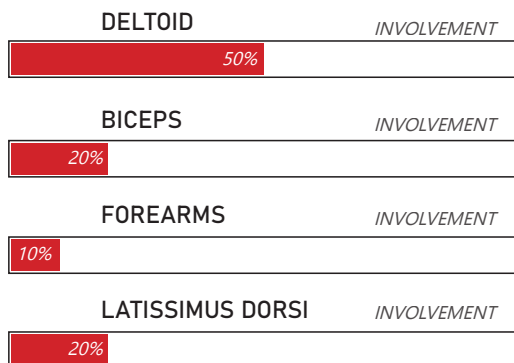
The biceps : these muscles allow the flexion of the arms but also their antepulsion (i.e. to raise them in front). It works in synergy with the deltoid and allows the maintenance of the planche, but also the management of the balance. Its involvement is accentuated when the one arm board is called «bent arm». Conversely, the tighter your arm is, the more force will naturally be redirected to the deltoid.

Forearm (extensors and flexors of the fingers) : the forearm will be used a lot, especially on the one arm planche on parallel bars. Indeed it allows to keep the stability and the control. For this you will have to grip the bar very tightly. Be sure to massage this area regularly to avoid inflammation and adhesions.

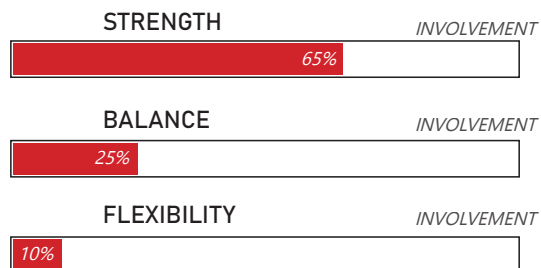
Obliques and intercostals : these muscles are very small and their main role is to maintain the ribs and lateral flexion of the rib cage. This sensitive area is put to the test during the one arm planche. Indeed, the compression of the obliques can be very painful at the beginning. It will be necessary to soften this area and to stretch regularly the two sides to avoid adhesions and pain. You must be vigilant because the risk of injury at this level is very high.



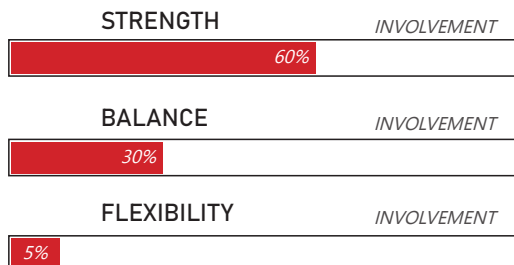
GENERAL OAP



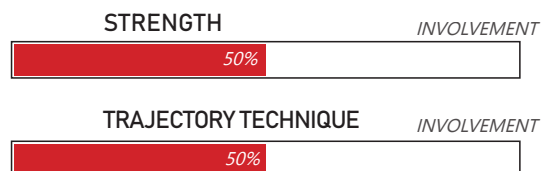
OAP GROUND



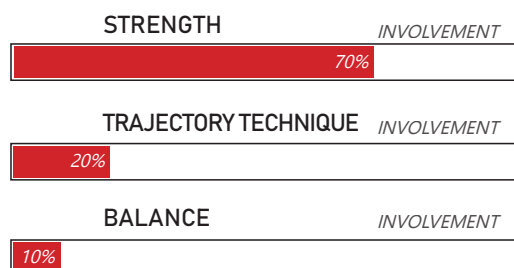
OAP ON BARS



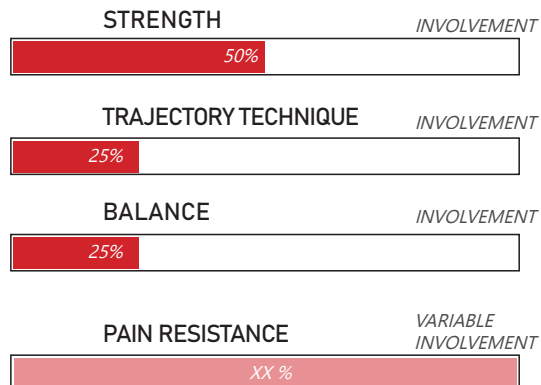
OAP PRESS



OAP PUSHUP



OAP FINGERS



PRESENTATION OF THE SIDED PLANCHES FAMILY



Very different from that of classic planches for which the body forms a straight line, the family of so-called 'sided' planches leads to its two highest-level skills : the one arm planche and the one forearm planche.

Although there are similarities between these two families, the sided skills require some work, specific to their constraints, as well as an adapted gesture to allow the correct placement of the center of gravity (above the support point), all by having the best possible form (good line, straight arms).

As for the other skill categories, there is a logical sequence of movements allowing progression by increasing the leverage, to achieve the

Final goal : to have the whole trunk and legs horizontal.

Mastering this category implies additional constraints and risks : this position is not in the natural axis of the body, and creates a mechanical disadvantage which adds flexion/compression stresses, especially in the obliques/lumbar regions.

From our personal experiences and what we have observed during our years of practice, without exaggerating, this category is the most dangerous in our sport (the one arm front lever, a skill with one arm also sided, is also particularly dangerous).

The mechanical disadvantage created by sided skills imposes a moderate frequency of work at the beginning, especially for the more advanced progressions.

Thus, it will be important to work on your flexibility regularly thanks to specific stretches, to improve your compression capacity in the obliques and the rib cage.

A wise approach is to start with skills whose intensity is within your reach, and which allows you to obtain the adequate volume of work.

Then, over time, progress will be made until you meet the necessary conditions to strive for the one arm planche.

A good handstand and a good one arm handstand on the ground as on parallel bars are always welcome: they are in line with the practice of the one arm planche, and it can be interesting to work them in at the same time.

The strength required for a sided planche is very different from the one which should be applied for a full planche with two arms.

The asymmetry induced by the side involves contractions of the shoulder girdle, the latissimus dorsi, the intercostals as well as the obliques : without these contractions, the link between the top of the trunk and its lower part is not assured.

WARM-UP

Before starting the real training, warming up is your priority. The risk of injury during this skill is high, so it is necessary to prepare all the areas that will be used.

- It will be necessary to emphasize the obliques and intercostals which will be put to hard test. Do some active flexing and stretching.
- The wrists will be just as important if it is the floor that you are aiming for.
- Also prepare your forearms because on bars, the stress can be quite significant.
- For the shoulder blades, you can mobilize and prepare them with a few scapula pushups (protraction, retraction)
- Think about the rotator cuff muscles by doing some basic rotations (external, internal) and some active stretching.

Both passive and active stretching during the warm-up phase can also be a great help to make sure you have full mobility during exercise. Restriction of mobility implies poor or compensatory muscular overuse and can be a risk.

Do not necessarily follow a warm-up routine. Listen to your body and adapt according to your needs.

FIRST STEPS

The first of the prerequisites in terms of control and flexibility is the handstand flag: the carrying arm is vertical or almost, while the opposite arm must be placed in opposition to the lever created by the body, to help maintain the skill by positioning the center of gravity above the support.



We can notice that the handstand ag and the one arm handstand flag are very similar : a perfectly positioned handstand ag hardly requires any support from the opposite arm.

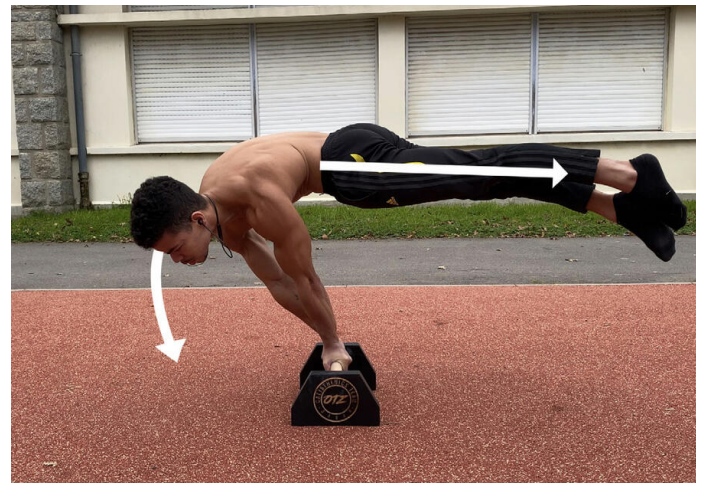


The handstand flag is an excellent tool for working on flexibility and compression capacity without taking too many risks. As this is not a planche, the orientation of the trunk for the handstand flag is different, since it is done with exactly the same trunk line as the sided planche. Therefore, mastering the handstand ag with one and two arms is a good way to ensure a correct approach with correct gestures that are necessary for sided skills.

Tips : too much tensions prevents good body positioning. You have to be relaxed as much as possible, while maintaining your body thanks to its extension (action which aims to try to make your spine as long as possible). A correct ratio between the contraction actions necessary for the side and the extension allows to add an additional link between the top and the bottom of the trunk, which ensures better stability.

SIDED PLANCHES

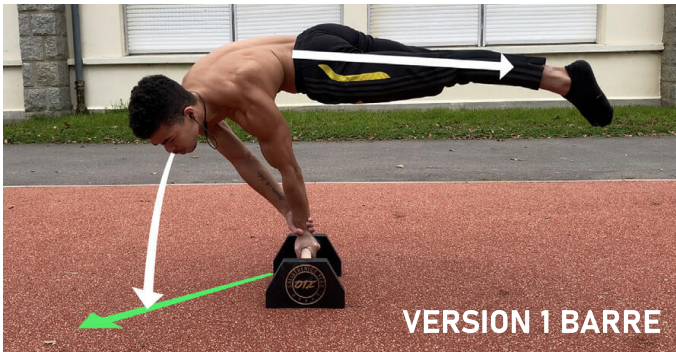
The different sides of planches represent the start of the path to the one arm planche. These are the main reinforcement tools in order to move on to the following stages : continuing to work a type of side after its acquisition allows you to get more strength without taking too many risks. In all cases, you should avoid a volume of work on one arm, that is greater than your capacities (depending on how you feel).



Ideally, an equitable work on each side should be done, as this helps maintain a good muscle balance between right and left. Without this equality, there is a risk of building up too much tension on one side, which can change your posture and/or block/move some bones/joints, and ultimately cause an injury. In practice, you will necessarily have a preferential side, which you will therefore work more than the other because it allows faster progression. If this is indeed the case, we advise you to stretch both sides equally to overcome the imbalances induced by your unilateral work.

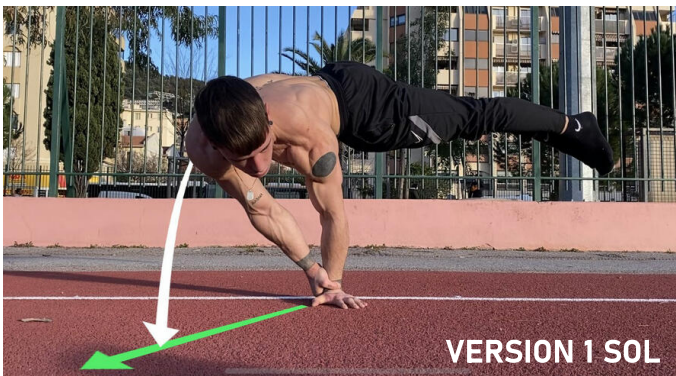


You can work on the different sides in isolation, or introduce them in any combination of skills, depending on the support you choose, and your level.



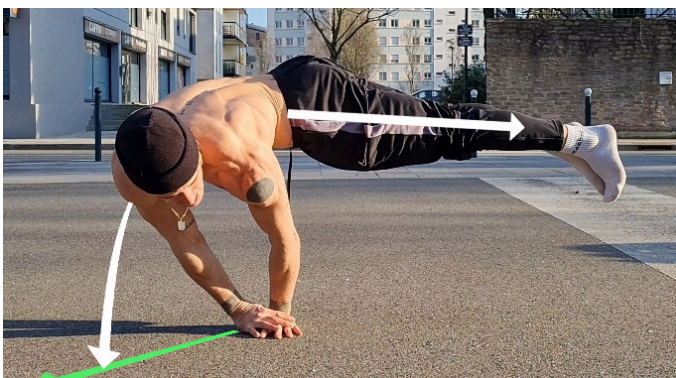
ASSISTED ONE ARM PLANCHES

Although several grips are possible for the one arm planche, the grip corresponding to the first version is the one which allows the muscular involvement closest to the one necessary for the one arm planche: the shoulders are almost at the same height, the side is similar and the working angle differs only a little.



LOGIC FOR OBTAINING THE ONE ARM PLANCHE

As mentioned previously, you must first get used to the sided planches and the handstand flag to master the various necessary prerequisites.



First, you can familiarize yourself with the handstand flag : once mastered, if you also have the two arms straddle planche, you can try to transition from the handstand to the handstand ag, then to straddle planche.

This transition is a very good way of reinforcement!

Do not hesitate to try different grips, they allow you to improve your understanding of body move-

ments, positioning, the distribution of contractions between different muscle groups, etc.

You can work these grips alone or include them in different combinations.

Once you are familiar with the sided work, you have built a base of sufficient strength to begin the first tests of assisted one arm planches, and one arm planche leans.

Training frequency and workload on one arm planches and assisted one arm planches should be moderate, especially at the beginning, with a maximum of two to three workouts a week.

ONE ARM PLANCHE ON THE GROUND

OAP LEAN



When your supporting hand is placed at on the ground, spreading your fingers apart but still remaining relaxed in the positioning, your thumb and pinky each point in a direction : the thumb indicates the direction in which you should point the top of your trunk in one arm planche and the little finger indicates the direction that the lower trunk and legs should have.

Clearly, during the one arm planche, the body must reflect the line formed by the thumb and little finger, with a curved portion between the two directions (which bodily results in flexion of the spine and compression of the obliques).

Put your hand on the ground and try to spread your fingers well, because the greater your contact with the ground/your bearing surface, the more control you have. The line carried by the thumb (or even the index depending on your mobility) indicates the path to take to perform the lean. You must then dive into the line of the thumb, forwards, that is to say to pass over your hand, while trying to keep both shoulders at the same height.

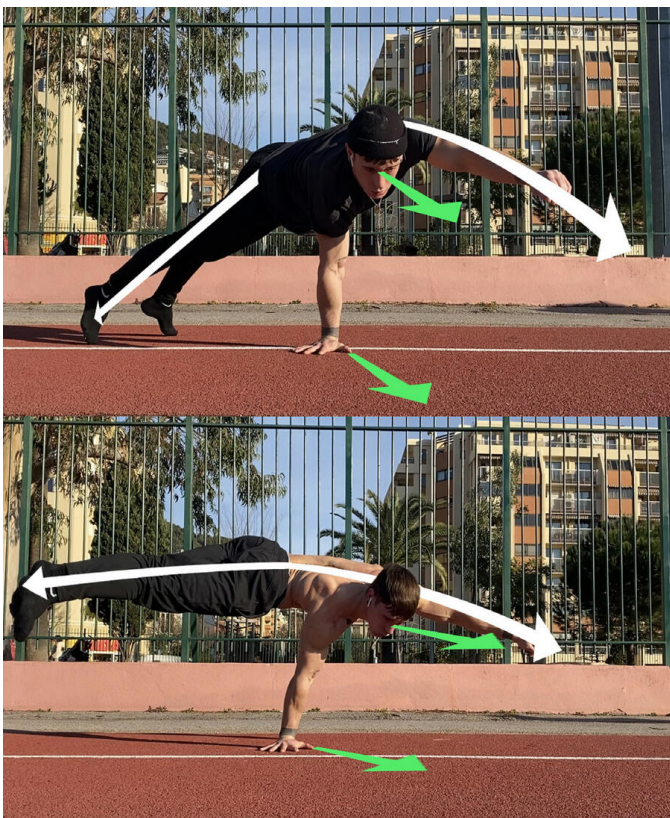
The line worn by the little finger is approximately the line your legs should follow. It is up to you to feel the exact direction to take, knowing that the right one allows you to find the point of balance, for which your center of gravity is above the support (your hand).



In the same way as the one arm handstand, the one arm planche requires to lock the scapula, at the front thanks to a slight external rotation of the shoulder, which also locks the elbow and involves the anterior deltoid, and at the back thanks to a sufficient involvement of the latissimus dorsi.

If you already have a fairly strong base of strength, you can try to do the lean by staying as straight as possible, but if you are just starting out, it will be necessary to intentionally neglect the form in order to start strengthening yourself on the movement.

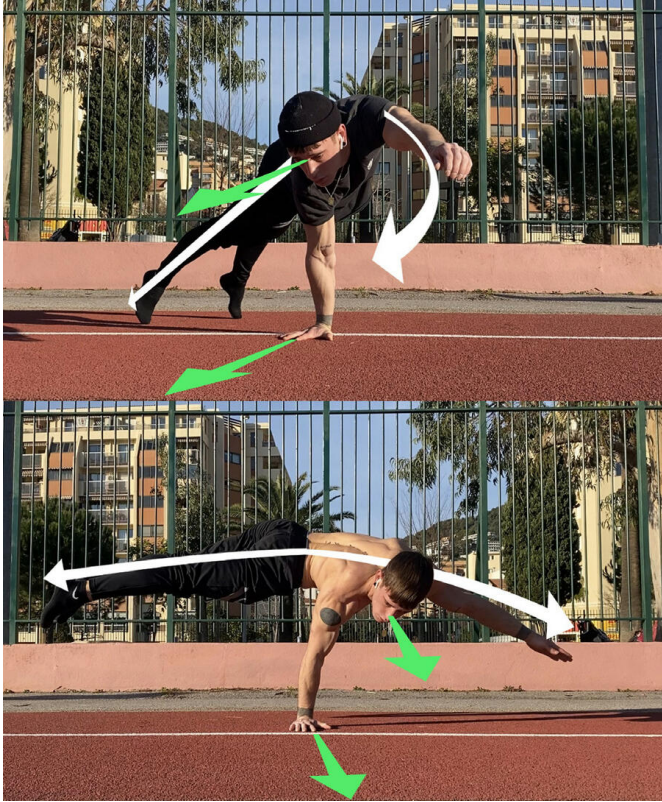
For instance, you can compensate for a lack of strength on the movement by bending the carrying arm, which allows you to roll forward, making it easier to bring the center of gravity close to the point of balance, what results in an easier take off.



A second solution aims to keep the arm fully extended during your lean, and compensate for the missing strength with your trunk. At first, you don't have to hold your whole body together: a graduated form of the one arm planche where the torso is bent forward (pelvis higher than the shoulders) and the legs are bent backwards (pelvis higher than the feet) is called a 'pike' or 'wallet'.

Only then will you have to dive down enough towards the thumb line to allow the take off, with the legs slightly hanging down.

As for any type of planche, extension is a key factor:



the more you grow, the more the movement is felt as simple and the better the shape is seen.

Tips : this trajectory, plunging, also happens to be the one for the press.

Many people think that a press is harder to do than maintaining the skill horizontal for a few seconds, which is not true.

Properly done, the press can be seen as a slight descent of the upper torso and a simultaneous ascent of the pelvis and legs, which can be mechanically seen as the union of a rotation of the body around the supporting shoulder and a slight downward translation of the shoulder.

An execution like this is easier than a one arm planche hold, and it is an excellent method to strengthen yourself, start doing skill combinations including the one arm planche and its press, to quickly find a recreational aspect to it, which will

allow you to progress even faster.

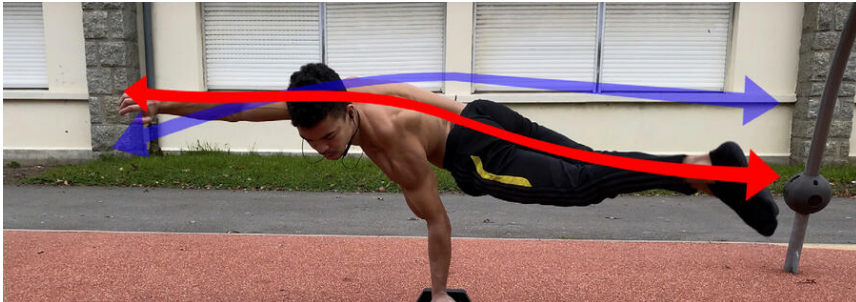
There are many possibilities to approach the one arm planche on the ground, corresponding to different shapes, each with benefits but also constraints. Concretely, these benefits and constraints arise from the working trajectory, directly related to your contact with the ground, which conditions the work of the wrist as well as the forearm.

The closer your working trajectory is to the line carried by your thumb, the higher and harder your one arm board will be to maintain, because in this case your thumb is the only element that allows you to effectively counter a forward tilt.

The closer your working trajectory is to the line carried by the index finger the lower your one arm board will be and the easier it will be to maintain, or even pushup thanks to the compression of the wrist.

A benefit never comes without constraint : getting too close to the axis of the middle finger has the consequence of making the press more complex, because one lacks height and therefore loses amplitude to join the trajectory of the press.

OAP 'BANANA'



This shape is often found in people who try to get a correct line on their first attempts, and who try to take off straight, no matter what.

A lack of strength or forward motion requires compensation to take off, and in the case of OAP banana this results in a rearward compression of the supporting scapula, and thus a bust that loses height to the pelvis.

To compensate for this lack of height, an over-compression is necessary at the level of the obliques, to make the legs rise.

This position, which generally implies a progressive retraction of the shoulder and the scapula, lacks a lot of alignment, thus stability, and proves to be the most dangerous.

As there is too much weight towards the back with this shape, a rear restraint is mandatory to keep the body in the air. This imbalance centralizes the weight on the lower part of the palm (at the wrist), which prevents the full involvement of the anterior arm chain, and conversely overstrains the posterior arm chain. To avoid falling backwards, the back should be arched so that the lumbar vertebrae pull the pelvis and legs upwards. This is like doing a one arm planche in the right orientation, but in the wrong direction. Don't forget that you absolutely have to go forward to do a planche.

OAP 'PIKE' OR 'WALLET'



The one arm planche called 'pike' or 'wallet' is the most logical and reasonable form available to you : having a downward trajectory towards the thumb/ finger automatically raises the pelvis, and tends to bring the legs closer to the torso, which reduces the amount of leverage needed for take off . It allows to have a relatively good balance between the involvement of the anterior and posterior chains of the arm, and therefore a more than correct

ground contact. The balance of this one arm planche, in addition to being achieved through ground contact, can also be achieved by managing the proportion between the advance in the thumb/index line (which adds leverage forward), and the wallet angle (how much you grow in the pelvis : the more you grow, the more leverage you add backward).

OAP 'BENT ARM'



The one arm planche called 'bent arm' is a very good way to strengthen yourself, to become familiar with the one arm planche. Bending the arm has the effect of rolling the body forward, which allows the center of gravity to be placed more easily than with the arm extended, moving forward

a little less. Moreover, if some joints/muscular chains are not yet fully ready to switch to a one arm planche work, this shape allows to relieve the weaker areas while recruiting even more the carrying arm, which allows a gain of strength in the arm by over-involving it.

OAP 'CLEAN FORM'



The one arm planche called 'clean form' requires a paradoxical gesture, for which one must both advance towards the line carried by the thumb/index and cross slightly inward to align the shoulders, and finish perfecting the shape. In terms of sensations, it is like taking height with the anterior chain of the arm, while one compresses towards the ground with the posterior chain of the arm.

It is also necessary to elevate the non-supporting shoulder by pulling the arm forward, also maintaining a protraction which has the effect of orienting the chest towards the ground : a default in the positioning of this shoulder has a direct effect on the orientation of the pelvis.

Squeezing your legs together will give you better hold in the position. Try to gain height with your heels, while keeping your line horizontal with your toes. These two combined and well- distributed actions allow you to expand as much as possible : this has the indirect consequence of posterior pelvic tilt.

The so-called 'perfect' shape is a subtle mix of strength and balance : an adequate trajectory and a sufficient side allow the center of gravity to be placed above ground support. In this case, the leverage is evenly distributed between the anterior and posterior chains of the arm, between the anterior deltoid and the latissimus dorsi (to lock the scapula). The anterior chain of your arm

provides forward restraint and should seek the smallest possible angle between the supporting arm and the body, while the posterior chain provides backward restraint, maintaining maximum height. More generally, these different contractions make it possible to counteract the resulting levers of the body mass shifted to the front and back of the support (and thus the center of gravity in the case of balance).

The mirror effect : as explained previously, each shape of one arm planche has its own trajectory. To allow the take-o and then the balance, the hand of your supporting arm must be below your center of gravity. Thus, to hold your one arm planche, there must be the same lever at the front as at the back, on the right as on the left, etc. A trajectory corresponds to a certain positioning of the bust, and the symmetry on the levers, necessary for balance, implies a positioning of the lower body (pelvis + legs) relative to this trajectory. This is called the mirror effect.

Example : if the bust is oriented downwards, with a non-supporting arm hanging down, the direct and unavoidable consequence is similar leg holding, with the feet lower than the pelvis (wallet). The pelvis can be seen as the mirror of the shoulders, and the feet as the mirror of the non-supporting hand (because at the end of the body).

If you want to have a beautiful line and a well-proportioned front/rear work, it only requires a good positioning. You will be able to get the most out of this muscle balance, and therefore reduce the risk of injury. By applying the mirror effect principle, having your shoulders level will allow you to have your pelvis oriented correctly, having the right activation of the shoulder and the non-supporting arm in the right direction will allow you to place your legs correctly. Conversely, having the non-supporting shoulder too high (lack of protraction) has the consequence of misaligning the pelvis and gives a so-called 'flag' appearance.

GROUND VARIANTS

OAP PUSHUP

The one arm planche pushup is a rare and very complex element to perform. With the front and back chains of your arm already carrying you, you have to find a way to maintain balance while developing. There are two solutions described below depending on your main direction of work.

- Thumb line: you don't have enough wrist flexibility to handle the front leverage, and your muscle chains are already fully recruited to maintain the skill. So you have to try to reduce the involvement of one side to be able to push, while the other side, over-involved, is in charge of maintaining the movement.

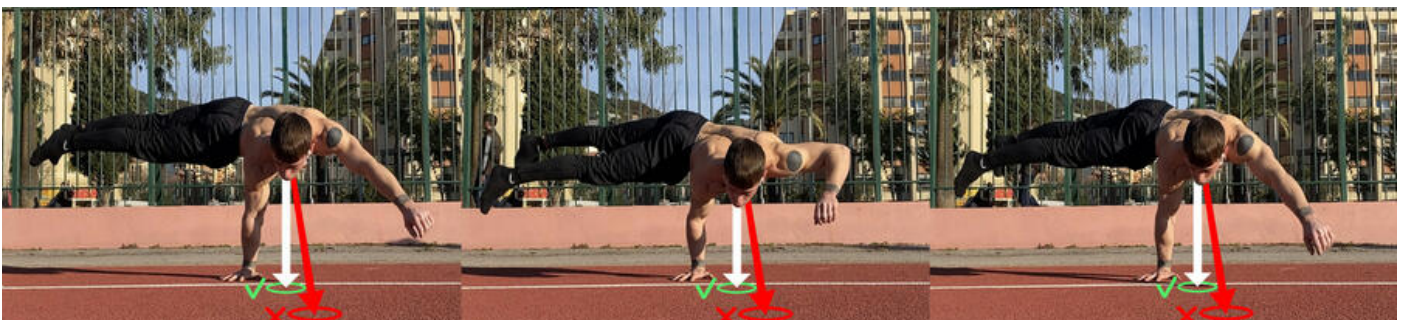
The solution is as follows : when you descend to the thumb line, you must lean slightly downwards, to centralize the pressure on the front of the hand so as to over-involve the biceps chain, in order to relieve some of the pressure on the triceps, to allow it to develop.

Then when you push, accompany the rise of the body with your head and your balance arm to resume your line and your height. This version is almost only done with strength, since one does not benefit from the compression of the wrist, which makes the full amplitude of the 90° extremely hard to achieve.

- Line of the index finger, or even the middle finger: as you descend, the angle of the wrist will gradually decrease, implying a compression that takes up the pressure exerted by the weight of the body.

This allows a good ease of development, and there will be little or no need for a dedicated trajectory to accompany the pushup.

Having tried both types of pushup (not having the same flexibility on both wrists), the compression of the wrist makes holding and pushup much easier. This requires about 70% strength and 30% wrist compression.



OAP PRESS



To press a one arm planche, synchronicity is required : first of all you have to dive with the balance arm and the head in the chosen direction, involving the front chain of the arm a lot and pushing on the carrying hand to pull the trunk upwards.

In addition, you must accompany this movement with your legs and feet in order to bring the pelvis and legs to the vertical of the shoulders, to end up in a handstand, or one arm handstand.

You can also almost see the press as a rotation of the body around the carrying shoulder, with a slight descent of the latter. To give you an idea, a one arm board press requires about 50% of gestures/synchronicity and 50% of strength.

ONE ARM PLANCHE ON PARALLEL BARS

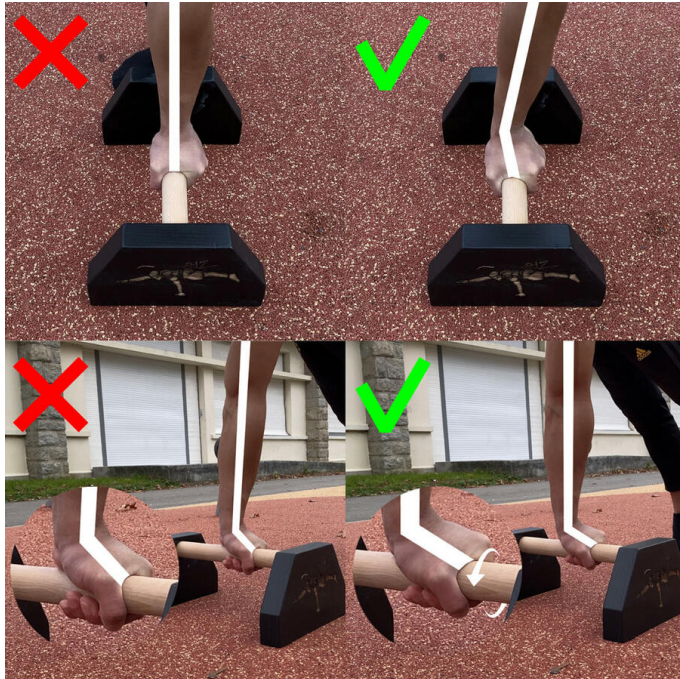
The one arm planche on parallel bars does not show major differences compared to the one on the ground. They only differ in the grip : on parallel bars, the contact surface with the support is less important, so it is necessarily more unstable than on the ground, where you can use your fingers completely to balance and adjust the positioning.



A good handstand and a good one arm handstand on parallel bars are obviously welcome : they are in adequacy with the practice of the one arm planche, and it can be interesting to work on them too.

Compared to the one arm planche on bars, the main advantage of the one arm handstand on bars is that it imposes much less stress and strain on the wrist, because the wrist remains almost in its natural working axis.

Therefore, it does not particularly require any prior preparation of the wrist, nor does it require extraordinary flexibility/mobility.



On bar, adjustments to remain in balance are made by tightening the bar (which requires a minimum of grip). A slight inward break of the wrist is recommended to obtain additional resistance, and also better stability.

The strength required for the one arm planche on bars comes mainly from the anterior deltoid. Your biceps also plays a very important role, especially at the beginning of learning where the supporting arm is usually bent, which makes it easier to position the center of gravity, and ensures better stability. Balance management with the arm fully extended is much more complicated than with a slight angle at the elbow.



OAP LEAN



The one arm planche lean on parallel bars is special because the support is raised from the ground, which makes it more difficult to take off from the trunk and legs, and increases the range to travel between the feet on the ground position and the position with the body parallel to the ground. At the beginning, it is more advantageous to start with the lowest possible parallel bars.



As explained previously for the practice on the ground, we advise you to start with less demanding forms such as the wallet so that you can quickly put volume on the leans, to obtain an optimal gain of strength. If you can't manage to lift at the beginning, which is quite normal, it is strongly advised to maintain the leans for at least five seconds (floor as parallel bars), moving forward enough to feel the difficulty, but without falling down too quickly, so as to strengthen and get used to muscles such as the anterior deltoid, biceps, forearm muscles and sensitive areas (obliques, intercostals).

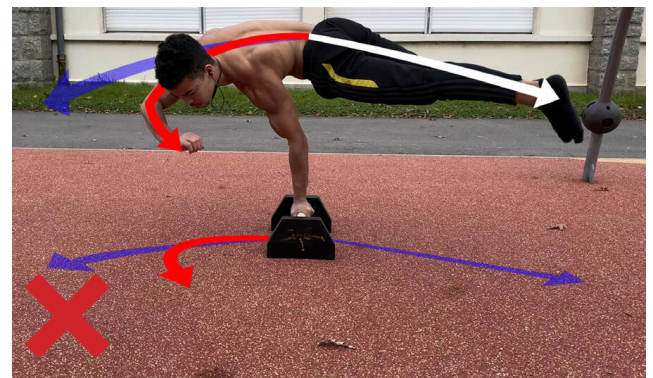
In general, it is always better to prefer the wallet rather than the banana which causes a compression of the scapula, an over-compression in the lumbar region, by letting the legs drag. Moreover, having a good side makes it easier to lift the one arm planche.

As for the one arm planche on the ground, an engagement of the latissimus dorsi, which allows to lock the scapula, is necessary.

At the beginning, opening the legs a little allows a better stability during the lean, and also facilitates its take off (small reduction of the rear leverage). Once you have pulled yourself up enough so that you are parallel to the ground, make sure you squeeze the bar very hard, because the grip is directly linked to the work of the forearm : this extra activation will directly increase your overall strength as well as your stability. Always break your wrist very slightly inward on the non-supporting arm side to gain even more activation.



In order to counteract as much as possible the rear lever generated by your legs, you have to use your non-supporting arm in order to add more lever on the front : it must be well engaged and go in the logical direction that allows you to move forward and therefore balance. Under no circumstances can the non-supporting arm be reduced to a 'dead' mass, because in this case it would be to your disadvantage.



What is important to remember is that the non-supporting arm, used appropriately, has a very important part in the realization of the one arm planche, first of all on the creation of the front leverage which allows to unload the front chain of the arm, but also on the balance play it allows.

Once you are able to take of your first one arm planches with the lean performed on bar, you now have to build the contraction scheme that allows you to optimize the movement, taking into account small details you may not have already considered. You have to do this 'research' work on yourself, and integrate all the little details you miss at the beginning of your path to the one arm planche, until they are automatic.

In summary, here are the main points to remember for the one arm planche lean on parallel bar and its take off :



- position your wrist correctly ;
- tighten the bar to gain strength and stability ;
- engage your latissimus dorsi to maintain your shoulder blade ;
- check that your side is sufficient without abusing it so that it does not cause you sharp pain ;
- use your non-supporting arm to add leverage to the front and gain stability ;
- deliberately contract your anterior deltoid and force it !

At the beginning, the goal is to achieve a massive gain in strength, don't focus too much on tightening your legs or having your arm outstretched.

Then, the shape will come naturally when you are used to the load, eventually you will be able to reduce the wallet.



OAP NEGATIVE

The one arm planche negative on parallel bars is the best exercise to apprehend the descent trajectory, gain strength and balance. By practicing this exercise regularly, you will notice how beneficial it is in terms of compression/ flexibility at the obliques/intercostals. Be careful, this is not a warm-up or stretching exercise. Before working on this movement, it is essential that the areas concerned are correctly warmed up/softened.



Optimal practice of this exercise requires a solid handstand, because if you lack stability it will be hard to get the desired trajectory, which can be frustrating.

Once in handstand, check that the wrist associated with the supporting arm is correctly positioned, oriented slightly inwards.

You can open your legs slightly in order to stabilize the negative more easily.

Then, from the first engagement of the negative, you should try to quickly orient the pelvis towards the ground.

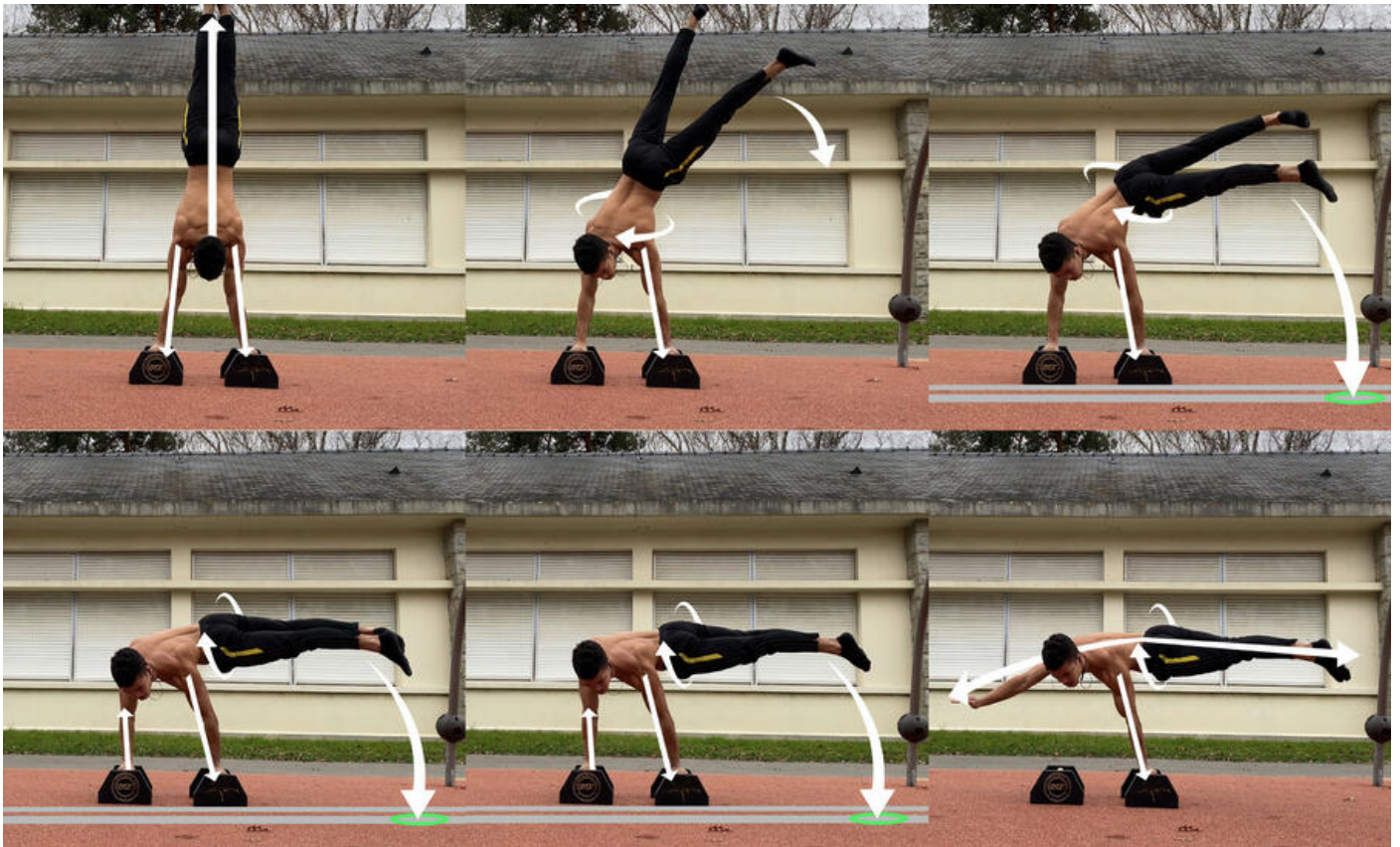
You can also do the negative with a light wallet, which facilitates the orientation of the pelvis towards the ground.

In the opposite case, where the pelvis is not correctly oriented, the shape is called 'flag' or 'half-flag'.

During your first attempts, do not hesitate to bend your supporting arm because, as we have mentioned several times before, the gain of strength is the main goal in the first place.

Do not forget to engage your latissimus dorsi as soon as you start the negative, to constrain the scapula and avoid any sagging which would be opposed to the work of the one arm planche.

Of course you have to side your body but within the limits of reasonableness : the more the one arm planche is sided, the less force it requires, because it reduces the rear lever.



The main work related to this exercise is to lower to the one arm planche position until it is parallel to the ground, while keeping contact with the two bars, to hold as long as possible.

Managing to maintain the wallet position from the negative on bars is interesting, but not very easy. This position is important because it forces you to orientate your pelvis towards the ground, which gets your body used to this position, and therefore allows you to improve your proprioception on this skill. After a while, you will have gained enough strength and ease in the movement to gradually reduce your wallet by straightening your legs and attening your pelvis, which increases the rear lever, or reducing the 'half-ag' by aiming the belly button towards the ground. In the end, you will have to tighten your legs, and lastly extend the supporting arm (don't rush too early on these two details, these are the last points to improve).

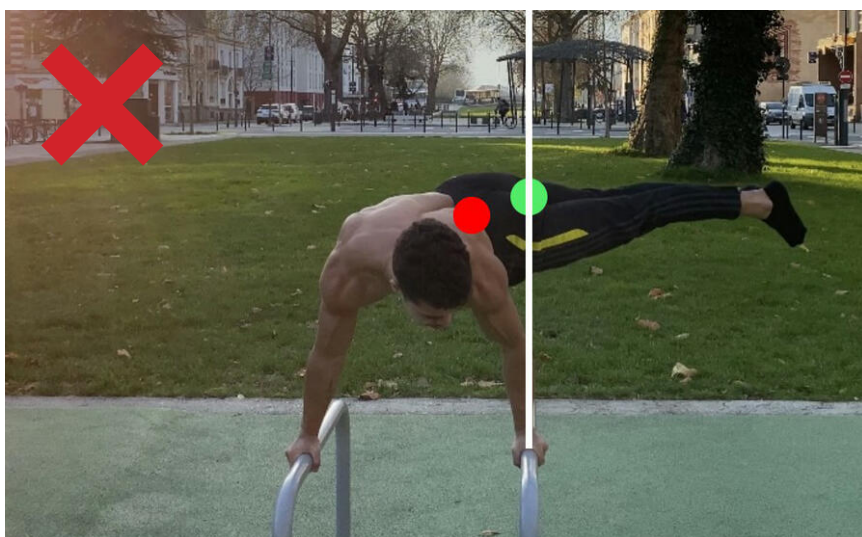
Once you have lowered the two-handed negative until you are horizontal, you have enough side as long as you are able to see your feet from the corner of your eye, without deflecting your head from its needed orientation for the one arm planche.



Over time, the one arm planche negative with assisted support at the bottom allows you to strengthen the obliques, intercostals, and the whole area that stabilizes the pelvis and legs properly. It allows both to accommodate this asymmetrical constraint and to gain strength on the supporting arm.

Even afterwards, when you have correctly assimilated all these new psychomotor possibilities, it will then be time to aim to reduce the force applied by the assistant arm, and thus to reduce the front leverage generated by the latter. It will therefore be necessary to try to counter the whole rear lever by moving forward a little more, and by forcing even more with the anterior deltoid of the supporting arm. If you feel comfortable with the two-handed hold, you can also try to do a press to go back to the handstand and try a negative again.

Repeat this exercise until you can completely remove the opposite arm.



BREATHING

Breathing control is an essential part of training, you have to take it into account to improve your progress.

No matter what discipline you practice, breathing helps supply oxygen to the muscles, which increases your endurance.

For our sport, breathing properly increases the duration of a skill and the duration of any combination.

Especially at the beginning, it is difficult to breathe properly because the skills are so hard to perform.

For one arm planche, the compression undergone during the first attempts prevents normal breathing.

You will probably feel that you are too compressed and cannot release the pressure to breathe properly.

But that is what you will have to manage to do over time.

Indeed, holding a skill in complete apnea is not enough, and especially not profitable for the progression.

You must therefore think about your breathing as you progress, to understand when to breathe, how much air you need to take before attempting a negative or a lean, and how much to release in order to feel a slight decompression at the obliques and thus obtain a few extra degrees on your side, so that you feel more comfortable and less cramped.

All these parameters have to be taken into account so that your ease on the one arm planche is optimal.

When you master a skill, you can breathe or speak as you wish without pain or constraint.

This means that your muscles, your skeleton and your air column are positioned properly.

Of course this is related to your strength, the stronger you are, the easier it becomes to think about these kinds of technical details.

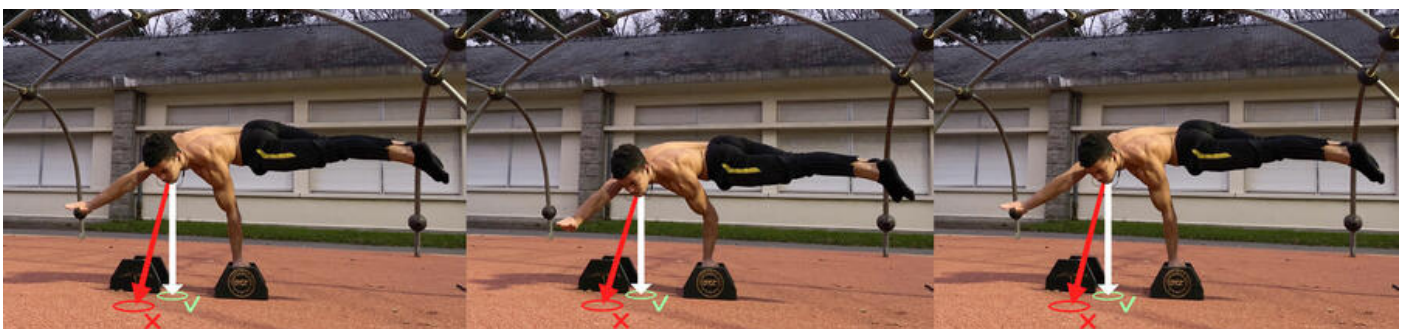
VARIANTS ON PARALLEL BARS

OAP PRESS



The gesture and the trajectory of the one arm planche press on parallel bars are the same as those described for the one arm planche press on the ground. (see page 19).

OAP PUSHUP



Despite the similarities between the trajectory of the one arm planche pushup on parallel bars and the one described previously on the ground, the full amplitude (90°) is much harder to achieve on bars. Not being able to choose between the different lines offered on the ground (thumb/index/middle finger), being on bars will make the full amplitude even harder. Nevertheless, biomechanically, it remains accessible. (see page 18).

ONE ARM PLANCHE ON FINGERS

The one arm planche on fingers is one of the ultimate variants of the one arm planche, and we are certain that very few athletes have ever acquired this skill. Two methods exist to achieve this variant, they are described below.

OAP ON FINGERS BY LEE-VAN



If you have the genetics that give you strong thumbs, or you have sufficiently strengthened/softened them, then this method is probably the most suitable for you.

Genetics plays an important role because it is necessary to be very flexible in the last phalanx of the thumb, so that you are able to achieve an angle of 90°, which is not accessible to everyone.

Knowing that for this way of doing, there is about 70 to 80% of your weight on the thumb. This mobility optimizes the engagement of the arm muscles, and results in increased stability.

The supporting arm is very close to supination, with the thumb at the front to support the front leverage, and the other four fingers of the hand oriented towards the pelvis and legs, to support the rear leverage.

The volume of work for the one arm planche on fingers is limited, because the strong pressure applied on the fingers, present at each try, ends up being felt as pain.



You should always listen to your body and know when it is necessary to stop in order to avoid injury. Resting automatically allows for reconstruction, and results in better resistance to stress for future workouts.

The trajectory of the lean leaves little room for maneuver, balance is extremely precarious and a small deviation from this trajectory often results in the inability to take off. Balance is mostly managed by the thumb, so it must be solid and stable. A slight opening of the legs also helps to be more stable. When learning by doing leans, a slight bending of the supporting arm at the elbow is welcome, as usual, to generate the necessary gain in strength.



If your side at the obliques is too important, you risk to do «the helicopter», that is to say that at the very moment you take off, your body will start to rotate more or less around the axis of your supporting arm and the balance of the one arm planche on fingers will be almost impossible.

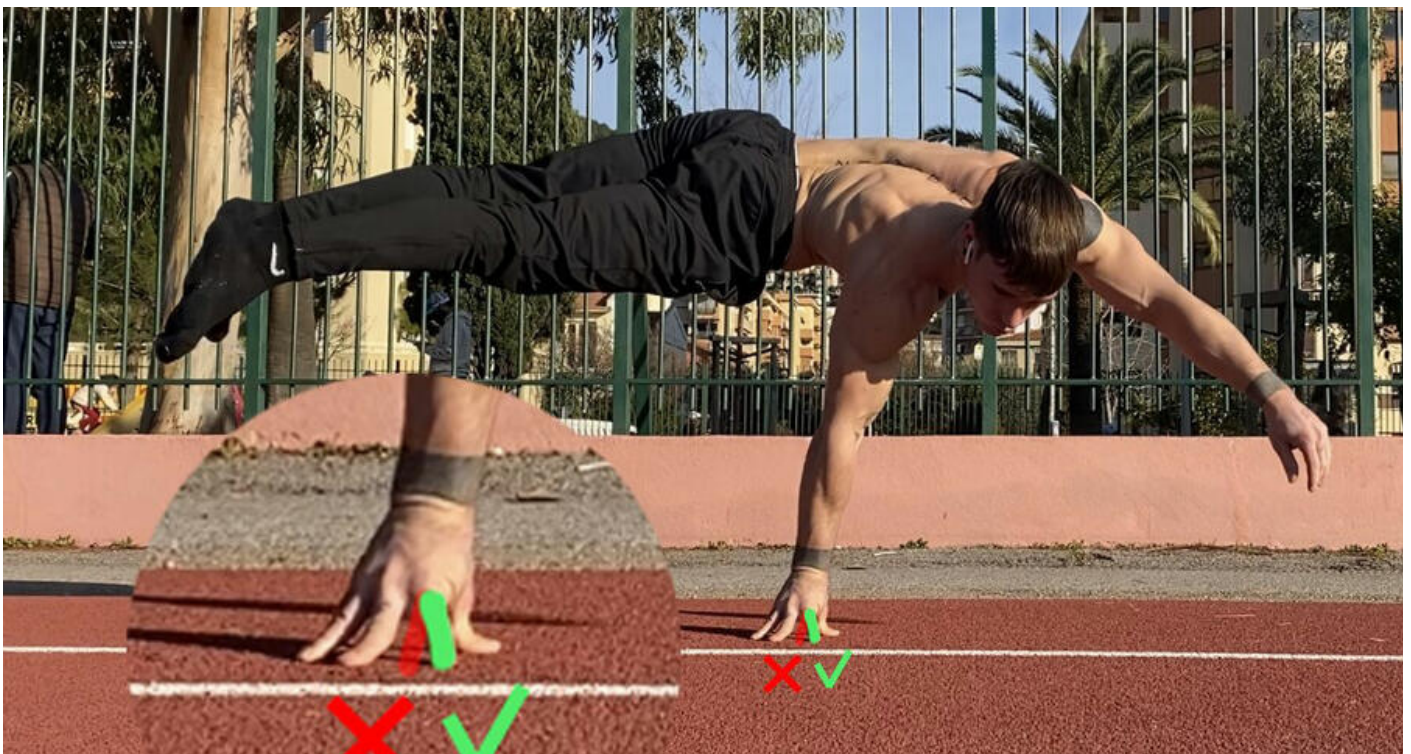
If you want to use this method, you need to strengthen all your fingers, and even more your thumb.

Some strengthening exercises such as push-ups on your thumbs first, then thumb planche, or even planche pushups on your thumbs can really help you to strengthen it.

Of course, in order to realize a one arm planche on fingers, it is necessary to have in mind and to apply all the principles of the one arm planche enumerated above, such as the use of the non-supporting arm, voluntary contractions of the anterior deltoid, of the latissimus dorsi, of the obliques, of the intercostals, etc.

OAP ON FINGERS BY VALENTIN

For this version, you should try to stay as elevated as possible on your fingers, and centralize the pressure at the level of the first phalanges. This is like trying to bring the fingers closer together once there is already a lot of weight on them. The thumb, almost straight and bent at 90° at the level of the first phalanx is mostly in charge of the inward restraint but also a little bit of the forward restraint. The index finger handles the rest of the front restraint, while the remaining three fingers handle the outside and back restraint.



First of all, you have to start the lean by advancing towards the line carried by the thumb with as much height as possible, and then you have to turn towards the line carried by the index finger, enough to allow the take off, while maintaining a maximum height.

OAP PRESS ON FINGERS

The gesture and the trajectory of the one arm planche press on fingers are the same as those stated for the one arm planche press, taking into account the additional elements relating to the work on fingers.

TRAINING SYNTHESIS

There is no real program or routine to apply that allows you to obtain the one arm planche, it is largely about understanding the movement and its activations, the trajectory to respect, etc. It is a long and complex work, which can be apprehended with the handstand flag, even before obtaining your first straddle planche. At this level, it is the best tool at your disposal to work on your balance, flexibility, and chest and rib compression capacities.

Working the one arm handstand on any support will bring you a great ease in the long run, because the management of the balance in the one arm planche is essential, even if the center of gravity is much lower than in the handstand (as a reminder, the closer the center of gravity is to the point of support, the more stable you are).

Once you are able to hold two-armed planches for a few seconds, you can start introducing all kinds of sided planches during your workouts, both in isolation and in combination moves. Once you get used to the two arms sided skills, you can try out the one arm assisted planches, a great strengthening tool. At the same time, you can gradually add more work on the one arm planche, depending on your physical abilities and your overall feeling. In this case, we advise you to include these two exercises as soon as possible : planche, press, flag, planche, in the form of repetitions or during your combinations, because the descent from the handstand to the planche by keeping the side to your maximum ability before restoring the symmetry allows to gain in nervousness, in proprioception, and thus to reinforce the mechanisms of the one arm planche ; the negative on parallel bars, in the form of maintenance or repetitions, also allows you to understand and anchor the right muscular involvements, positioning, while strengthening yourself. It can be followed by a descent to a planche, and extended to any combination of your choice.

Throughout your strengthening work, you must practice the one arm planche leans on the ground as well as on the bar, applying the advice and indications contained in this book, in order to assimilate the trajectory to be respected and its gestures. The leans will allow you to strengthen your anterior deltoid, which is the most involved muscle during the one arm planche. This will complement the other movements/exercises given above.

If you feel better on parallel bars, focus on the negatives, but do not forget to include leans on the ground, if their execution does not cause pain in the wrist, which allows you to focus more on the deltoid and the whole anterior chain of the supporting arm.

If you are more comfortable on the ground, work on the appropriate line (thumb/index/middle finger), according to what your wrist mobility allows you.

Do not hesitate to make many different attempts to explore all your possibilities.

If your leans take off on one foot and you fall while wrapping yourself, it means that the trajectory is still perfectible, or that you may have forgotten to apply a previously stated principle.

If your leans take off from both feet and you fall forward, it is on the right track, you probably still lack of strength, keep going !

Even if you particularly like the ground, most of the reinforcement work is done on parallel bars, so you should not neglect it.

Once you have maintained your first one arm planches, by doing a lean or a negative, follow the advice we give you in order to assimilate them correctly, because every detail counts. Moving from a one arm planche with bad form to a horizontal one arm planche, pelvis to the ground, with the carrying arm stretched out, requires a monstrous amount of work.

That being said, the merit will be even greater in the end !

At first, the volume of training dedicated to the one arm planche should be limited to your abilities. You have to work hard enough while being careful, and being aware of when you need to stop and rest.

The progressive increase of this volume of work will be done naturally in a second step as your body's capacities improve.

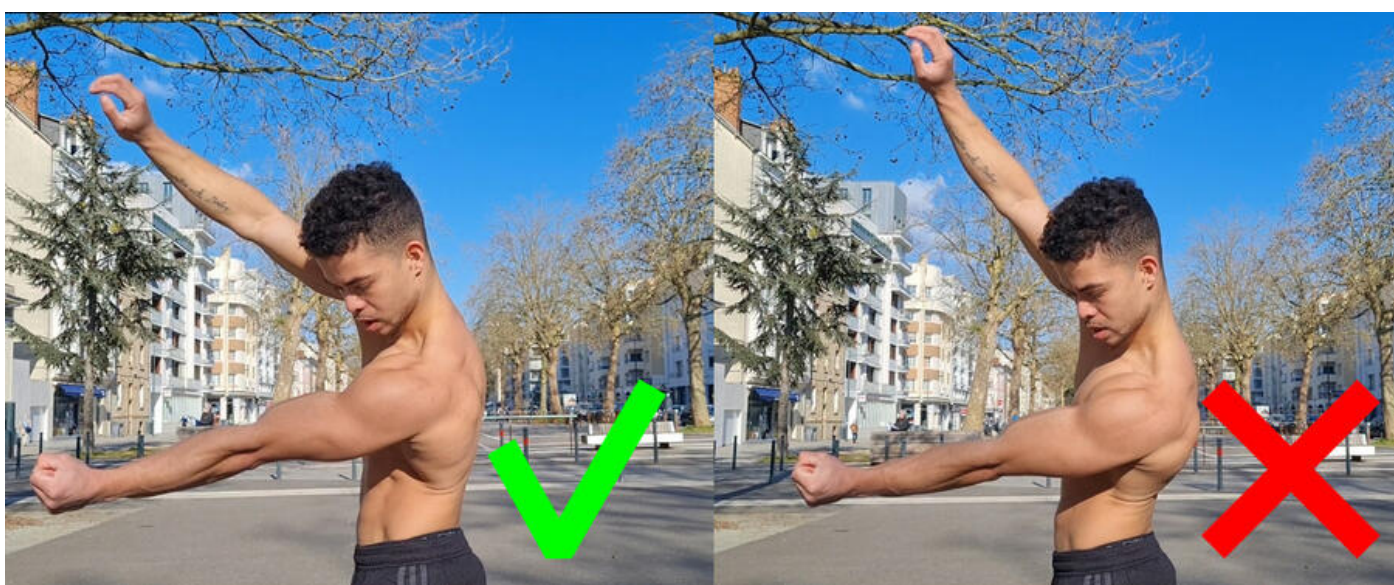
In this context, we advise you to remain reasonable in your practice and to listen to your body, because the risks of injuries related to the one arm planche are great. Many injuries resulting from overtraining will make you lose time.

At the slightest pain that persists in one of the places described in the figure, massage yourself with a small ball and stretch by following the exercises we suggest in the dedicated part of this ebook.

If you experience tension/pain that persist during your training, or even worse, the rest of the time, we advise you to contact a health professional (sports doctor, physiotherapist, osteopath) as soon as possible, who is able to diagnose you. For instance, he will manipulate you in the moment if it is relevant, in order to restore the functions of your body that are causing the problem.

MUSCLES/INJURIES

The area of the scapula can easily be traumatized if the movement is poorly executed. If your deltoid and latissimus dorsi are poorly engaged, or not yet strong enough, this can result in a compression of the scapula. As with the two-armed planches, this sagging of the scapula or retraction, is very dangerous, and can be the cause of certain lesions or injuries that will slow or even stop your progress.



The latissimus dorsi is a very important muscle for a correct execution of the one arm planche. It must be completely involved in order to maintain height in your one arm planche, which will facilitate a long hold, and eventual presses which will be much easier. As mentioned above, it plays an essential role in avoiding a compression of the scapula. The fact that it is raised and 'laid' on your latissimus dorsi reduces oblique tension and therefore the (unpleasant and potentially dangerous) feeling of crushing in this area.

The forearms muscles are extremely solicited during the one arm planche, there is no real risk of injury but a lot of tension can accumulate, this is why we strongly advise you to massage yourself regularly with a massage ball, or a massage gun if you own one.

Wrists, intercostals and latissimus dorsi will be strained and can also be impacted. An adapted and regular warm-up and conditioning are recommended.

Beware, you should not practice one arm planche every day, with high intensity, it is the best way to hurt yourself, and therefore to slow down your progression. Two to three training sessions per week are more than enough at the beginning. As we have already said several times, the volume of work and frequency of workouts will naturally increase as your body adapts and your abilities allow you to do so.

SPECIFIC ONE ARM PLANCHE CONDITIONING

It is imperative to gain flexibility as well as compression capacity. Too many constraints associated with a lack of mobility result in erroneous muscular INVOLVEMENTs, which can some- times prevent from performing in extreme cases.

We insist one last time on the fact that the one arm planche is a very constraining movement, because it is asymmetrical. The trunk and the legs are kept outside their respective natural axes, so it is particularly dangerous. Therefore, you have to devote a lot of time to maintain your body in good health, in order to perform at your best and in a sustainable way. Whether you practice left or right, stretch your obliques evenly. Treating tension only on one side and leaving it on the other side can involve a muscular imbalance, which can have bad consequences in the medium and long terms.

You will also need to stretch your legs frequently and fully. Tensions accumulated in the lower part of the body can affect the pelvis, the spine, and even the entire body. After an operation, one of us has become hyperlaxed in the pelvis, and a fall with a landing on the knees has caused a slight rise of one leg, therefore a modified gait, and a greater load on the lower leg. The stress accumulated in the lower leg eventually moved up to the pelvis, through the vertebrae, and eventually created dysfunction in some upper areas of the trunk, such as the right portion and the cervical vertebrae.

It is wrong to think that the maintenance of the lower parts of the body is not important, as the upper parts are mostly used when performing skills. This is a huge mistake, because the body is composed of many chains that link these upper and lower parts. Dysfunctions affect each other so that they balance each other.

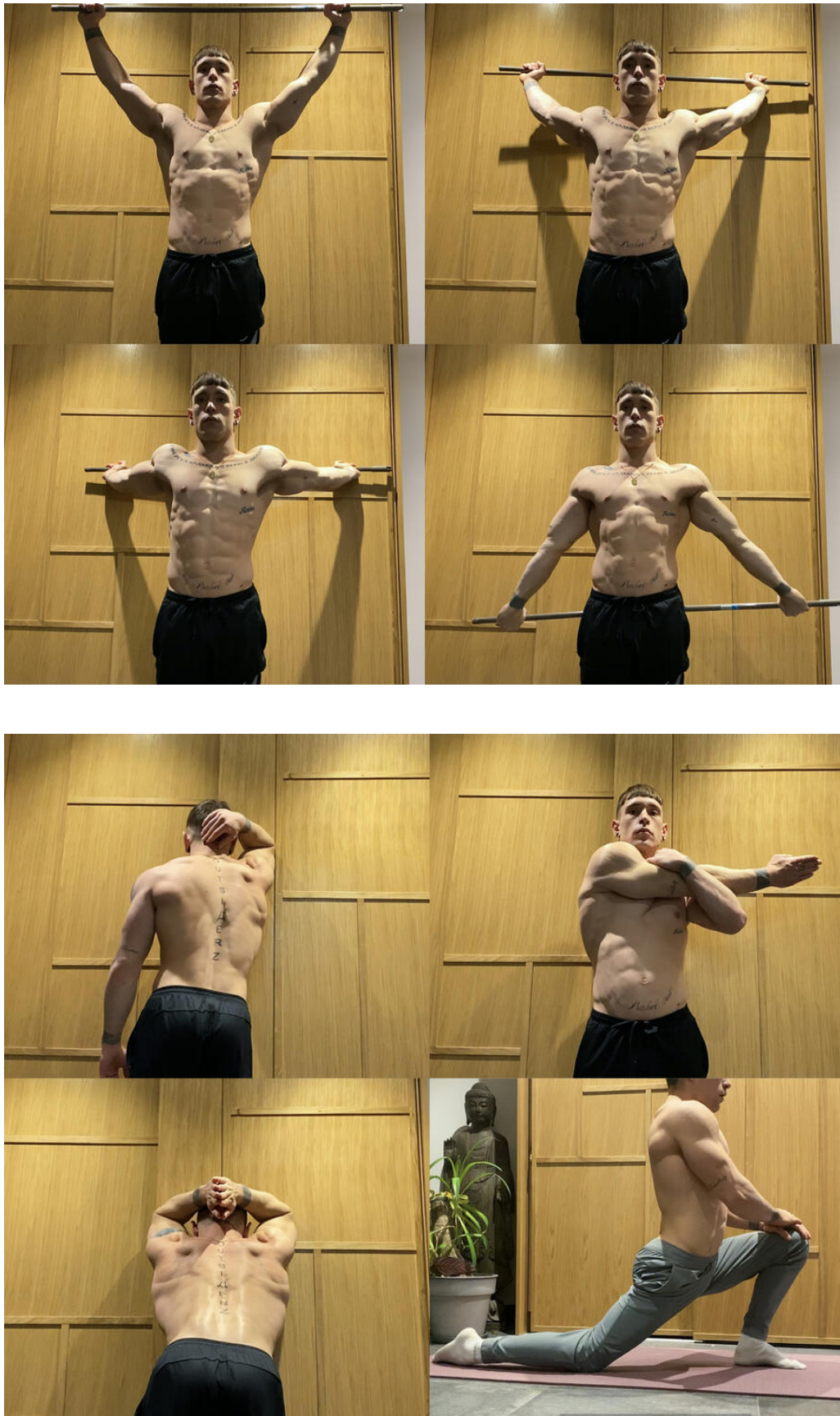
Finally, here is a list of stretches that we practice daily, during the day as well as during the warm-up.











THANKS

This content was realized by Valentin Blanc and Lee-van Rollé, with the active participation of Dai-long Huynh and Pascal Brault. Our sincere thanks to :

- Dai-long Huynh, for his help in reviewing and checking the document, as well as editing the photos present in the ebook. Member of our 'Outsiderz' team and professional Calisthenics athlete, he is also a qualified sports educator and student in L3 STAPS in education and motor skills in Rennes.
- Pascal Brault, for having helped to reformulate the content in order to make it as pedagogical as possible, as well as for the translation into English. Partner of the team on many aspects and practitioner of Calisthenics, he is a professor of industrial sciences for the engineer and a PhD student in robotics at the IRISA of Rennes.